Athletic Trainer Pay: $35/Hour

GUHSD pays Athletic Trainers $35/hour — set in 2021–22 and unchanged since. The California Athletic Trainers Association recommends a minimum of $67–$73/hour for our region. Six of seven SD County peers employ AT as a classified healthcare role with benefits and BOC certification required.

GUHSD AT RATE
$35/hr
$22,500 stipend = $35 × 214 hrs × 3 seasons. Rate unchanged since 2021–22; other groups received 8% (2023), 1% (2024), and 2% (2025) increases.

CATA RECOMMENDED (REGION 5–6)
$67–$73/hr
California Athletic Trainers Association minimum per-diem rate, cost-of-living adjusted for SD County.

INJURY RATE RATIO (PIERPOINT 2018)
6× / 3×
Recurrent injury rate ratio in girls' soccer / girls' basketball at schools without ATs (Pierpoint et al., 2018).

Three reference points

1. **Student safety (Pierpoint 2018, peer-reviewed).** Schools without certified ATs see **6× higher recurrent injury rates** in girls' soccer and 3× in girls' basketball. Four GUHSD sites (El Cajon Valley, Mount Miguel, El Capitan, Santana) currently rely on walk-on trainers.
2. **Title IX (U.S. Dept. of Education OCR, Morgan Hill USD, October 2023).** The OCR resolution requires "equitable access to the school's athletic trainer" regardless of booster-funding source. GUHSD uses CTE teacher-trainers at 5 sites and walk-on trainers at 4.
3. **Market rate (CATA 2022).** GUHSD pays roughly half of CATA's recommended minimum for any region of California, and less than half the recommended rate for Southern California.

Contracted vs. actual hours (Granite Hills trainer)

Element	Contracted	Actual / Impact
Months of work	9 months	**10.5–11 months actually worked** (per the Granite Hills trainer)
Hours per season cap	214 hours × 3 seasons = 642 hours	Average ~17 hrs/week; football and winter sports exceed that
Reported effect	**—**	**Spring sports get less AT coverage because high-demand fall/winter sports consume more than the per-week budget**

> *"ATs are currently contracted/paid for 9 months of work, but we end up working 10.5/11 months. We are currently being paid $35/hour to work 214 hours per season (there are 3 seasons). This averages out to about 17 hours per week. However, certain sports/seasons require more than 17 hours per week (such as football, winter sports, etc.) which leaves less hours for other sports/seasons."*
> — Katherine Leek, Granite Hills HS Athletic Trainer (April 2026)

PRIMARY SOURCES

GUHSD *Athletic Trainer Staffing and Financial Realignment Proposal* (internal). California Athletic Trainers Association *Certificated Athletic Training Pay Discrepancy Proposal.* Pierpoint et al., *Injuries in girls' soccer and basketball: a comparison of high schools with and without athletic trainers,* Injury Epidemiology 5:29, 2018. U.S. Dept. of Education OCR, *Resolution of Title IX Athletics Investigation of Morgan Hill Unified School District*, October 2023. California AB 796 (Statutes of 2024). Pickett et al., *Factors Influencing Athletic Training Services in California Secondary Schools: A 5-Year Update*, J. Athletic Training, 2024. EdJoin postings 1528322 (SDUHSD AT), 1093003 (Oceanside USD AT). Direct verification: K. Leek, Granite Hills HS AT (April 2026). Full report:
JDAVIS-NETIZEN.GITHUB.IO/GUHSD-ATHLETICS-FUNDING-REPORT